UPSC COMBINED DEFENCE SERVICES (CDS) EXAMINATION

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE (GS) — OFFICIAL CHAPTER-WISE ANSWER KEY & DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

CHAPTER 1: Indian Polity & Constitution

Q.#	Paper	Correct	Official Solution / Constitutional / Scientific Rationale
1	CDS (II) 2024	(A)	Statement 1 is correct: Quo-Warranto is issued by the High Court or Supreme Court to inquire into the legality of a claim by a person to a public office. Statement 2 is incorrect: Unlike habeas corpus or certiorari, any public-spirited citizen can move the court for Quo-Warranto; the petitioner need not be an aggrieved person.
2	CDS (I) 2024	(A)	Article 141 of the Constitution provides that the law declared by the Supreme Court shall be binding on all courts within the territory of India. Article 142 relates to complete justice enforcement.
3	CDS (II) 2023	(C)	A Constitutional Amendment Bill can be initiated in either House of Parliament (Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha) and not in state legislatures. It does not require prior recommendation of the President.
4	CDS (I) 2023	(B)	Articles 15, 16, 19, 29, and 30 are available ONLY to Indian citizens. Articles 14, 20, 21, 21A, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, and 28 are available to both citizens and foreigners.
5	CDS (II) 2022	(B)	The Speaker of Lok Sabha presides over a joint sitting of both Houses of Parliament (Article 118(4)). In the Speaker's absence, the Deputy Speaker presides; in their absence, the Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha presides.
6	CDS (I) 2022	(B)	Under Article 3 of the Constitution, Parliament may by law form a new State or alter the area, boundaries or name of any State by a simple majority.
7	CDS (II) 2021	(B)	The Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV, Articles 36-51) were borrowed from the Irish Constitution (which had copied them from the Spanish Constitution).
8	CDS (I) 2021	(B)	The 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978 substituted 'armed rebellion' for the vaguer phrase 'internal disturbance' to prevent arbitrary imposition of National Emergency.

CHAPTER 2: Indian History & Freedom Struggle

Q.#	Paper	Correct	Official Solution / Constitutional / Scientific Rationale
9	CDS (II) 2024	(A)	Evidence of a ploughed field with criss-cross furrows was discovered at Kalibangan (Rajasthan). Lothal is famous for its tidal dockyard; Dholavira for water harvesting.
10	CDS (I) 2024	(B)	Gopal Krishna Gokhale founded the Servants of India Society in Pune in 1905 to train national missionaries for the service of India and promote social advancement.
11	CDS (II) 2023	(A)	The Poona Pact was signed on 24 September 1932 at Yerwada Central Jail between Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, replacing separate electorates for depressed classes with reserved joint electorate seats.
12	CDS (I) 2023	(C)	The Third Buddhist Council was convened in 250 BCE at Pataliputra under the patronage of Emperor Ashoka and presided over by Moggaliputta Tissa. The Abhidhamma Pitaka was compiled here.

13	CDS (II) 2022	(D)	The Cabinet Mission sent by Clement Attlee in March 1946 consisted of three British cabinet ministers: Lord Pethick-Lawrence, Sir Stafford Cripps, and A.V. Alexander. Lord Wavell was the Viceroy of India, not a Mission member.
14	CDS (I) 2022	(B)	Veer Kunwar Singh of Jagdishpur (Arrah, Bihar) led the 1857 Revolt in Bihar with exceptional guerrilla warfare tactics at the age of nearly 80.

CHAPTER 3: Geography (Physical, Indian & World)

Q.#	Paper	Correct	Official Solution / Constitutional / Scientific Rationale
15	CDS (II) 2024	(C)	Barren Island in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands is the only confirmed active volcano in India and the South Asian subcontinent.
16	CDS (I) 2024	(B)	The Aravalli Range is one of the oldest fold mountain systems in the world, formed during the Proterozoic eon, now deeply eroded into relict mountains.
17	CDS (II) 2023	(C)	The McMahon Line was negotiated between Tibet and Great Britain at the 1914 Simla Convention, defining the boundary between Arunachal Pradesh (India) and Tibet/China.
18	CDS (I) 2023	(A)	The Damodar River was historically known as the 'Sorrow of Bengal' due to frequent catastrophic floods before the construction of the Damodar Valley Corporation (DVC) dams. Kosi is the Sorrow of Bihar.
19	CDS (II) 2022	(B)	In the Southern Hemisphere between 40° and 60°S latitude, the lack of landmasses allows the prevailing westerlies to blow with extreme unobstructed velocity, termed Roaring Forties, Furious Fifties, and Shrieking Sixties.
20	CDS (I) 2022	(B)	The Benguela Current is a cold ocean current flowing northward along the southwest coast of Africa in the South Atlantic Ocean. Gulf Stream and Brazil Current are warm Atlantic currents; Kuroshio is in the Pacific.

CHAPTER 4: General Science & Defence Systems

Q.#	Paper	Correct	Official Solution / Constitutional / Scientific Rationale
21	CDS (II) 2024	(B)	Myopia occurs when the eyeball is too elongated or cornea too curved, causing distant rays to focus in front of the retina. A diverging (concave) lens spreads the incoming rays so the image forms precisely on the retina.
22	CDS (I) 2024	(B)	Sodium and potassium are highly reactive alkali metals that react violently and exothermically with water and oxygen at room temperature, releasing combustible hydrogen. They are safely preserved immersed in kerosene.
23	CDS (II) 2023	(C)	Mitochondria produce adenosine triphosphate (ATP) through cellular respiration and oxidative phosphorylation, thereby serving as the powerhouse of eukaryotic cells. Lysosomes are suicide bags.
24	CDS (I) 2023	(C)	BrahMos (named after the Brahmaputra and Moskva rivers) is a joint venture between India's Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya.
25	CDS (II) 2022	(B)	When sodium bicarbonate (baking soda, $NaHCO3$) reacts with acetic acid (vinegar, $CH3COOH$), sodium acetate, water, and carbon dioxide ($CO2$) gas are produced. The rapid release of $CO2$ produces vigorous effervescence.

26	CDS (I) 2022	(C)	The Western Naval Command is headquartered in Mumbai (Maharashtra). The Eastern Naval Command is at Visakhapatnam (Andhra Pradesh), and the Southern Naval Command (Training) is at Kochi (Kerala).